

James O'Connor

Java Backend Developer

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Summary

Results-driven Java Backend Developer with 3 years of experience building scalable production systems. Expert in leveraging Spring Boot, Kafka, and PostgreSQL to deliver high-performance solutions through cross-functional collaboration. Committed to driving technical ownership and measurable engineering impact.

Experience

Senior Java Developer — FinServe (2015 – Present · Dublin, Ireland)

- Architected a high-throughput payment processing system, ensuring 99.9% uptime for critical financial transactions.
- Spearheaded mentorship initiatives for junior developers, fostering a culture of technical excellence and code quality.
- Standardized engineering documentation by creating comprehensive technical runbooks and architectural decision records.
- Optimized CI/CD pipelines using Java-based automation, resulting in a 30% reduction in software delivery lead times.

Software Engineer — NovaLabs (2012 – 2014 · Dublin, Ireland)

- Collaborated with product stakeholders to translate business requirements into robust, scalable Java features.
- Enforced rigorous code quality standards through peer reviews and the implementation of automated unit and integration testing.
- Authored detailed technical specifications and system documentation to streamline onboarding and maintenance.
- Automated repetitive development workflows, significantly accelerating the deployment cycle for core services.

Junior Developer — BrightStack (2008 – 2011 · Dublin, Ireland)

- Contributed to the full software development lifecycle, delivering incremental value in a fast-paced Java environment.
- Participated in active code reviews and test-driven development to minimize production defects.
- Maintained internal knowledge bases and technical runbooks to support team operational efficiency.
- Streamlined development processes by automating manual tasks, improving overall team productivity.

Projects

Internal reporting toolkit — Developed a lightweight ETL pipeline and dashboard using Java to visualize and track team performance metrics.

Open-source side project — Maintained an open-source utility library dedicated to implementing clean Java design patterns.

Education

BSc Software Engineering — Trinity College Dublin (2014)

Earned a BSc in Software Engineering with distinction for a capstone project focused on complex data systems.

Professional specialization course — Online platform (Coursera / edX) (2015)

Completed professional specialization coursework to maintain proficiency in modern backend development stacks.

Skills

Java · Spring Boot · Kafka · PostgreSQL · Maven · Python · FastAPI · Django · Redis · Docker

Certifications

AWS Cloud Practitioner

Languages

English